

ROLEXGRANDSEIKO ANALYSIS

Rolex

Grand Seiko

Critical Analysis

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Critical Analysis

Grand Seiko &

Rolex

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This work aims to carry out an analysis that seeks to compare the presence online (in the field of online advertising with an exclusive focus on Google Search Ads) of two direct competitors of the chosen brand (OMEGA) for the final project which, in this case, are: Rolex and Grand Seiko.

These brands have markedly different positions when it comes to the watchmaking ethos that design, produce and sell, this Ethos, which also manifests itself in the way build your Ads, from Headlines to Descriptions.

Introduction

Rolex

Grand Seiko

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01

02

02

Rolex

Grand Seiko

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“Print Ads”

Subtle, textured natural Japanese aesthetic.

Prestige, performance, achievement, eternity.

03

03

Luxury watches sell Aspiration and Status and not just the measurement function the passage of time.

TOFU (Notoriety) is Offline: Built with emotional and expensive channels (Sponsorships, Elite Events, Print Ads).

MOFU/BOFU (Digital) is Surgical: Search Advertising is used with accuracy to manage Consideration and Action (conversion).

Recent Impact: Acceleration of e-commerce forced Rolex to defend image and Grand Seiko being aggressive in digital conversion.

01.

02.

03.

TOFU

MOFU

BOFU

Contextualization
of the Sector

Grand Seiko

04

04

Discreet and contemplative positioning, focused on perfection
craftsmanship and subtle innovation.

Foundation (1960): Created to rival the luxury market

Swiss through precision engineering.

Late External Presence: The brand only arrived as an entity
independent outside Asia in 2017.

Core Message: The Ethos emphasizes meticulous care,
high precision and natural beauty of design.

Marketing: Privileges poetic and technical messages, reflecting
Japanese culture.

Rolex

Grand Seiko

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ROLEX

A

Rolex

sell

Prestige,

Durability

and

Recognition

Universal.

Foundation (1905): History consolidated in Geneva, pioneer in innovations (Caixa Oyster, Movimento Perpetual).

Positioning: Global icon of luxury, with a strong emphasis on Robustness and Reliability.

The Ethos: Based on the tradition of innovation and durability, consolidating its reputation as Authority and Prestige.

Digital Implication: Marketing reflects the need to maintain and control this status digitally.

Rolex

Grand Seiko

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05

05

Ads

chosen

01

Ad Grand Seiko

06

06

Grand Seiko

Rolex

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Ads

chosen

02

Ad Rolex

07

07

Grand Seiko

Rolex

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phase

Funnel

Summary: GSA is used to surgically filter traffic
(MOFU/BOFU), while Awareness is built offline.

COVID and Digital: The accelerated transition forced brands to position
the GSA critically.

Rolex: Uses the GSA as the primary point of contact in the
Consideration

(MOFU),

focusing

in

Image

Corporate

and

Authority.

Grand Seiko: Integrates GSA as a crucial channel of Action (BOFU), focused
in Market Growth and immediate conversion in the West.

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Rolex

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Grand Seiko

09

09

Grand

Seiko,

grand

seiko

model, grand seiko models,

grand seiko collection, grand

seiko collections, grand seiko

where to buy grand seiko

watch, grand seiko price,

grand seiko acquire

grand seiko boutique lisbon,

grand seiko spring drive, grand

seiko prices

grand seiko watches, grand

seiko spring drive movement,

Keyword Planner Suggestions

(too many vague points

more like "TOFU")

Hit

Different

Ad

No Hit

Search

Terms

01

02

03

Grand Seiko

Rolex

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-

10

10

- grand

seiko

spring

drive

movement

- port

[grand seiko]

"grand seiko model" / "grand

seiko models"

"grand seiko collection" / "grand

seiko collections"

"grand seiko price"

"grand seiko price" / "grand

seiko prices"

"grand seiko acquire"

"grand seiko boutique"

Negative

Keywords

MOFU

BOFU

Keywords

01

02

03

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1111

rolex,

rolex

watch,

rolex

models, rolex collection, rolex

luxury, used rolex

rolex

Daytona,

rolex

submariner,

rolex

hulk

submariner, rolex gold, rolex

store, rolex boutique lisbon

rolex price, rolex buy,

rolex

delivery,

rolex

investment, swiss rolex, rolex

hulk (nickname)

Hit

Different

Ad

No Hit

Search

Terms

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- [rolex watches] / [rolex watch]
- [used Rolex]
- [rolex price] / -[rolex prices] / -

[rolex buy]

- [rolex

where

buy)]-[rolex

delivery]

- [rolex investment] / -[swiss rolex]
- [rolex pepsi] / -[rolex hulk]

[Rolex]

"rolex watches" / "rolex watch"

"Rolex

models"

/

"Rolex

model"

"luxury rolex" / "used rolex"

[Rolex

daytona]

/

[Rolex

submariner]

"rolex hulk submariner" / "rolex

pepsi gmt"

"gold rolex" / "steel and gold rolex"

"Rolex

locator"

/

"Rolex

botique finder" / "rolex

distributors

Negative

Keywords

MOFU

MOFU+

+

Segmented

Keywords

01

02

03

Grand Seiko

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Analysis

Visual

Grand

Seiko (Ad)

1. Message and Content (Alignment with Ethos)
2. Asset Strategy (Conscious Choice of ROI over Branding)
3. Execution Inefficiencies (Sitelinks)

Rolex

Grand Seiko

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Analysis

Visual

Grand

Seiko (Landing Page)

1. Information as afterthought (MOFU in “fourth plan”)
2. The “complexity” of the Conversion Journey (MOFU to BOFU)
3. Performance Highlight (The Benefit of Efficiency)

Rolex

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Strengths

Aligned Content: Clarity in writing and descriptions that appeal to interest through references to artisanal work.

Asset Wealth: High number of sitelinks uploaded to the platform (although with consistency failures).

Analysis

Review

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Weaknesses

Funnel Inconsistency: Mixture of MOFU and BOFU phases between main Ad, sitelinks and landing page.

Lack of Personalization: Lack of Business Logo and Display Path.

Linguistic Dissonance: Headlines and Descriptions feature a mix of languages.

Sitelink Redundancy: Different sitelinks ended on identical pages.

Analysis

Review

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Highlights

Landing Page & Homepage: Visually incredible design and homogenization between main website and the online boutique is an interesting point.

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Landing Page Website

Landing Page Boutique

Improvements

Enhanced Targeting: Create more ad groups to avoid mixing MOFU and

BOFU.

Sitelink Consistency: Ensure that all sitelinks point to the correct phase of the funnel (BOFU).

Visual and Linguistic Coherence: Homogenize the languages presented and add Business Therefore (prioritizing cost-benefit).

Dedicated Landing Pages: Creation of specific Landing Pages to receive traffic from paid ads, simplifying the conversion process.

Analysis

Review

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Rolex Visual Analysis (Ad)

1. MOFU Strategy and HNWI Psychology
2. Control and Narrative Consistency
3. MOFU Personalization and Sitelinks

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Analyze

Visual

Rolex

(Landing Page)

1. Visual Perfection vs. Price (MOFU Strategy)
2. The Sacrifice for Perfection
3. Consideration-Optimized UX (Cookies)

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Strengths

Communication Maturity: 120 years of history reflected in clear and consistency of headlines and descriptions.

Psychological Segmentation: Highly segmented sitelinks allow you to satisfy Exact user search intent.

Funnel Control: Concern that all sitelinks coexist at the same stage of funnel (MOFU).

Personalization: Use of customized Business Logo and Display Path for greater authority.

Intelligent User Experience: Landing Page that "remembers" the user's last visit.

Analysis

Review

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Weaknesses

Linguistic Inconsistency: Use of Brazilian Portuguese in ads delivered in Portugal (due to the pt-br URL), which may create slight dissonance.

Analysis

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Highlights

Content Perfection: Unquestionable quality and visual design.

Incredible Above the Fold Design: The first impression of the Landing Page is authority and aspiration.

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Improvements

Linguistic Localization: Use of Portuguese from Portugal in ads delivered to the Portuguese market for total coherence.

Analysis

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Rolex - The “weapon
secret”

Rolex's mastery lies in its dual Control strategy that uses
bidding in its own name for the MOFU and the Distributor network
Authorized Authorities (DAs) to capture BOFU traffic.

The ultimate goal is to “close” the sale and “compile” the sales metrics
conversion through DAs, maintaining your “brand image” of
exclusivity and desirability while optimizing the final phase
of funnel (BOFU).

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Rolex

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Grand Seiko

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Rolex - The “weapon
secret”

Rolex

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Grand Seiko

Traditional Rolex (TOFU)

Digital DA (BOFU)

Digital Rolex (MOFU)

Carlos' Journey

The Google Search Ads dispute between Rolex and Grand Seiko is not a race, but a confrontation of philosophies.

Rolex pays the price of Authority and Control (MOFU) by defending every pixel on the screen to ensure that consideration is never tainted by action.

On the other hand, Grand Seiko plays the Efficiency and ROI (BOFU) game, sacrificing the premium position in order to, in return, achieve the objectives of the corporation.

The digital thus becomes a battlefield where the Swiss “Unquestionable Status” meets the “Ambitious Optimization” from Japan.

Conclusion

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Grand Seiko

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Grand Seiko

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Thank you!